

Breakfast Edition Month 2: Lesson 1 – Joseph

The Young Dreamer

 **Theme:** From pit to purpose

 **Background Text:** Genesis 37; 39; 41–42

 **Key Verse:** Genesis 42:6 (WEB)

“Joseph’s brothers came, and bowed themselves down to him with their faces to the earth.”

 **Appetizer – The Dream That Started It All, Genesis 37:5–8 (WEB)**

“⁵Joseph dreamed a dream, and he told it to his brothers, and they hated him all the more. ⁶He said to them, ‘Please hear this dream which I have dreamed: ⁷for behold, we were binding sheaves in the field, and behold, my sheaf arose and also stood upright; and behold, your sheaves came around, and bowed down to my sheaf.’

⁸His brothers said to him, ‘Will you indeed reign over us? Or will you indeed have dominion over us?’ They hated him all the more for his dreams and for his words.”

Joseph saw a glimpse of his future long before anyone else believed it. What God showed him made his brothers jealous and angry, but their feeling didn’t invalidate the fact that dream still came from God.

 **CST – Called Before You’re Ready**

God can give us glimpses of our destiny before others are ready to believe it—or before *we* fully understand it. Favor can feel lonely when the people closest to you don’t see what God has spoken over your life.

Reflection:

How do you stay humble when God’s favor on your life creates tension with others?

Main Course

Bite 1 — Betrayed but Chosen, Genesis 37:19–22, 28 (WEB, summarized)

¹⁸ They saw him afar off, and before he came near to them, they conspired against him to kill him. ¹⁹ They said to one another, ‘Behold, this dreamer comes. ²⁰ Come now therefore, and let’s kill him, and cast him into one of the pits...’

²⁸ Midianites who were merchants passed by, and they drew and lifted up Joseph out of the pit, and sold Joseph to the Ishmaelites for twenty pieces of silver. They brought Joseph into Egypt.

The very people who should have protected Joseph became the ones who betrayed him—but their evil could not cancel God’s plan.

CST – When Betrayal Becomes a Bridge

Sometimes betrayal doesn’t block your destiny—it *pushes* you toward it. The pit felt like punishment, but it was really a passageway. What others meant for harm, God was already folding into His larger story of rescue and preservation.

Reflection:

Think of a time when someone’s betrayal or rejection pushed you into a new chapter. How might God have been redirecting you?

Bite 2 — Integrity in the Dark, Genesis 39:7–8,10 (WEB)

⁷ After these things, his master’s wife set her eyes on Joseph; and she said, ‘Lie with me.’

⁸ But he refused, and said... ‘How then can I do this great wickedness, and sin against God?’

¹⁰ As she spoke to Joseph day by day, he didn’t listen to her...”

Joseph guarded his character even when no one from home was watching and when compromise might have seemed to make his life easier. His integrity and personal conviction mattered more in the moment than the temptation to be agreeable..

CST – Holiness When No One’s Looking

Holiness means running away from what others explain away. Joseph understood that sin isn’t just

breaking rules—it’s breaking God’s heart. He chose obedience over opportunity, even though it cost him his reputation and his freedom.

Reflection:

What guardrails (boundaries, habits, or people) help protect your integrity when temptation keeps coming “day after day”?

 Bite 3 — From Prison to Palace, Genesis 41:14, 16, 38 (WEB)

- ¹⁴ Then Pharaoh sent and called Joseph, and they brought him hastily out of the dungeon...
- ¹⁶ Joseph answered Pharaoh, saying, ‘It isn’t in me. God will give Pharaoh an answer of peace.’
- ³⁸ Pharaoh said to his servants, ‘Can we find such a one as this, a man in whom is the Spirit of God?’”

In one day, Joseph went from prisoner to prime minister—but he made sure the glory went to God, not himself.

 CST – Hidden Preparation, Sudden Promotion

God was preparing Joseph in places people forgot about: the pit and the prison. Those “wasted years” became his training ground in leadership, humility, and dependence on God. When the door finally opened, Joseph was ready—not because he was perfect, but because he stayed faithful.

Reflection:

Where do you feel “hidden” or overlooked right now? How might God be quietly preparing you for your next assignment?

 Dessert — Faith Rewarded Genesis 42:5–6 (WEB, summarized)

Because of the famine, the sons of Israel came to buy grain in Egypt. Joseph, now governor over the land, was the one selling to everyone. His brothers arrived and bowed before him with their faces to the earth—just like the dream from his youth.

Reflection – When the Dream Matures

God’s dreams don’t die; they develop. The boy with the dream became the man with the responsibility to save many lives.

What promise from God have you carried for a long time that you’re starting to see unfold—or that you need to keep believing for?

To-Go Box

- The **pit**, the **prison**, and the **palace** were all part of Joseph’s training, not random pain.
- Betrayal couldn’t block God’s plan; it became the bridge God used to move Joseph into position.
- Integrity in hidden places prepared Joseph to carry influence in public places.
- God’s promotion often comes suddenly, but the preparation is usually slow and silent.
- What God speaks in a dream, He will fulfill in His time—our job is to stay faithful “through,” not just shout about the promise at the start.

Closing Prayer

“Lord God, thank You for the story of Joseph and for reminding us that You are working even when life feels unfair. Help us to trust You in the pit, to walk in integrity when no one is watching, and to stay faithful in seasons where we feel forgotten. Strengthen our faith to believe that Your promises will come to pass in Your perfect timing. In Jesus’ name, amen.”

Reflection Questions

Where do you see yourself in Joseph’s journey right now—pit, prison, palace, or somewhere in between?

Write down one promise, dream, or calling from God that you refuse to give up on, even if it seems delayed.

Activity – Fill in the Blank

1. Joseph's brothers sold him for _____ pieces of silver.
2. Joseph resisted the temptation of _____.
3. Pharaoh said Joseph was filled with the _____ of God.
4. Joseph's brothers bowed before him in _____.

(Check the Appendix for answers)

Notes Page — Group Discussion & Personal Study

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